business inc.

Starting a business?
Let us help boost your plans

IMPORTANT

You must save this application form to your computer before you begin.

PC and Mac users, be sure to use to complete this application.

Download at
a e.com/products/reader.html

What's in it for you?

- ✔ A new or refined business plan
- ✔ One-on-one consultation with a business advisor
- ✔ A certificate of completion
- ✔ A network of other entrepreneurs

Application form

Personal information

First name: Ivan

Last name: Damnjanovic

Address: [redacted]

Province: Québec City: Montréal Postal Code: [redacted]

Telephone: [redacted]

Email: ivan@ambientsystems.ai

Submit the application via fax or email to .
Questions? Call

The personal information on this form is collected under the authority of the Public Libraries Act and the Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act. This information will only be used for the provision services and programs by Toronto Public Library, Toronto Business Development Centre and the City of Toronto. Questions related to the collection of this personal information should be directed to the City Librarian's Office, Toronto Public Library, 789 Yonge Street, Toronto, ON, M4W 2G8. Telephone: .

TORONTO tpl toronto public library

Academic & employment background

Education (Include any courses that will support the success of your business)

School(s): University of Toronto, National University of Singapore, University of Belgrad

Area(s) of study:

Applied Science (Civil Engineering), Computing (Computer Science), Economics (Business Management)

Level completed: Bachelor, Master, PhD (active)

Year completed: 2015, 2021, and started in 2024

Other (training programs, certification, etc.):

Carnegie Mellon Uni, Action Community for Entrepreneurship (ACE), Singapore Management University (SMU)

Have you completed any other self-employment training program in the last five years?
If so, describe (program name, location, year).

No. Only programmes for startup fundraising.

Business-related employment history

Current employer, if any:

Company name: Ambient Systems

Position: Founder/Director

Previous employers:

Company name: Centennial College

Position: Post-Secondary Professor (Part-time contract)

Company name: Deloitte Canada

Position: Risk Analyst (Internship)

Relevant skills that will support the success of your business:

Business Development, Fundraising (pitching), and Engineering

Have you ever been self-employed: ☐ yes ☑ no

If yes, give details (e.g. what, when, where, functions you performed):

Ambient Systems is an active, institutionally-funded, and globally recognized AI startup from Singapore with an existing presence in Canada (Montreal, Quebec) -- none in Toronto or Ontario. This program will support our localization process, strengthen compliance with local standards, and help refine our go-to-market strategy for the city (municipality). With a strong technical base and international traction, we are now looking to make Toronto a sustainable anchor for our local operations. The Business Inc. program is an ideal strategic step. Ambient Systems is

Business outline

1. Business profile

Have you started your business? ☑ Yes ☐ No

If you answered Yes, how long have you been operating your business? 1 year (in Canada)

If Yes, what is the name of your business?

Solutions Flux d'IA (DBA: Ambient Systems)

Will your (or is your) involvement in your new or early-stage business full-time or part-time?

Volunteer

If you are starting a new business, when do you plan to start operation?

Already active

Will you (or do you) have majority control of your business?

100% control

Describe the product/services offered by your business in 15 words or less.

AI-powered systems solutions for finance, infrastructure, and industrial operations — global footprint, now localizing in Toronto.

2. Product / Service Description

Provide a more detailed description of the products/services offered by your business. Outline key features and benefits of your products/services.
(Add additional pages if additional space is needed for any of the following sections.)

Ambient Systems provides AI-powered SaaS and consulting solutions designed for financial institutions, infrastructure operators, and operations-intensive businesses. Our core services include intelligent process automation, predictive analytics for asset and equipment management, financial systems optimization, and infrastructure lifecycle monitoring. These offerings are tailored for mid-sized enterprises that lack in-house AI capacity but require reliable, cost-effective modernization. We specialize in rapid deployment, full IP handover, and scalable systems that adapt to local standards. With successful operations in Singapore, Hong Kong, and Quebec, Ambient Systems is now expanding into Toronto (and potentially Ontario) with offerings aligned to the city's industrial, regulatory, and operational needs.

3. Market Overview

Tell us about the market for products/services offered by your business. Who are your customers? What needs do they have for products/services? Why would they buy from your business rather than the competition? Have you researched or undertaken any market analysis (e.g. Library, Statistics Canada, on-line research, yellow pages, trade associations, customer surveys, etc)? How will you market to potential customers? (e.g. in person, store, mail, trade shows, distributors, over the Internet, etc.) Describe why you think this existing business or proposed business idea is viable from a market perspective.

Ambient Systems targets mid-sized financial, infrastructure, and operations-heavy firms in Toronto that need affordable, tailored AI solutions to modernize outdated systems. These customers typically lack in-house AI capacity and are underserved by large vendors whose offerings are costly and overly complex. Through market research using Toronto Public Library resources, Statistics Canada data, and direct outreach to over 500 Ontario-based leads, we identified potential for lean, practical automation and predictive analytics tools tied with financial operations Our competitive edge lies in delivering founder-led, cost-effective solutions with local customization and no vendor lock-in. I plan to reach customers through in-person meetings, workshops, and strategic digital outreach, making this a highly viable business opportunity in a digitally evolving market.

4. Competitive advantage

Tell us about your competition. Who are they? What are their strengths and weaknesses? What gaps, if any, exist in the marketplace? What is your competitive advantage?

Our competitors include large vendors like IBM and Palantir, which offer powerful but costly and complex solutions, and smaller consultancies that lack deep AI expertise. The market gap lies in affordable, customizable AI systems for mid-sized firms. Our competitive advantage is delivering lean, transparent, founder-led solutions with fast deployment, full IP handover, and strong local adaptability—ideal for Toronto's underserved mid-market sector.

5. Financing

Financing is critical to the success of any business. Applicants are encouraged to consider the amount of financing required to start their business and sources of funding available to them. This information will be helpful in assessing your application.

How much money do you think is required to start your business: $ 30000

How much of the above-noted amount do you have available now
to invest in your existing business or proposed business idea: $ 2000

What additional funding are you seeking: $ 28000

Where do you think you will obtain this financial support:

☑ Personal investment: $ 2000

☐ Family support: $

☐ Bank loans: $

☑ Other: $ 28000

6. Work in progress

What steps have you already taken to make your proposed business idea a reality?

To bring this business to life, we have already registered a Canadian company (Quebec-based) and initiated business development across the country, with over 6,000 finance sector leads identified--many in Toronto. We've built out foundational processes, marketing assets, and internal best practices, all informed by a recent grant-backed R&D and NSERC-funded development. Our product is fully operational and now undergoing adaptation for the Toronto and Ontario market. We are currently based at the Toronto Public Library's North York Central branch (Entrepreneurial Suite), with plans to expand into a co-working space in North York or the city to support local client engagement and business growth.

7. Looking ahead

What concrete steps are you planning to take in the next six months to move your business forward?

Over the next six months, our focus is on localizing Ambient Systems for the Toronto market, which differs from our international operations by emphasizing domestic production and self-reliance:

1. Active BD: market positioning, outreach, feedback validation (specific to Toronto)
2. Regulatory foundations: standards, certificates
3. Resource: secure grants or founder capital to get started
4. Employment (underway): secure 1-2 part-time local staff for administration tasks with founder/director as technical anchor for project success.
5. Project execution and delivery: local pilots

Additional Information

How did you find out about this program?

Event

Did someone recommend this program to you? ☑ yes ☐ no

If yes, who: North York Central Library

Check one:

- ○ I already had a valid Toronto Public Library card.
- ○ I registered for a Toronto Public Library card in order to participate in this program.
- ☑ I renewed my Toronto Public Library card in order to participate in this program.

Preferred Location:

Danforth/Coxwell

Participant requirements

You must be 18 years of age, have a valid Toronto Public Library card and have a potentially viable business idea to be eligible for the program. All applications will be reviewed by a selection panel. Limited to 40 participants, there is no guarantee that you will be accepted into the program. Only one individual per business can be eligible for the program. The $150+HST program fee will be due upon acceptance into the program.

All program participants agree to:

- Start a new business within a six-month period or accelerate the growth of their early-stage business
- Attend and participate in all workshop sessions
- Work to complete a comprehensive business plan for review by a business advisor
- Participate in a follow-up email questionnaire in six months

I have read and agree to the "Participant requirements".

Type or print your name: Ivan Damnjanovic

Date (MM/DD/YY): 05/02/25

Attach any other materials or information on your exisiting business or proposed business idea. (ie, brochures, plans, etc).